



HE'S READY
Lloyd flings helmet at practice
C3

NBA
Hawks beat Magic for 10th straight win
C3

TENNIS
Seles wins Australian Open
C3

HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL
Elyria Catholic falls to Lake Catholic
C4

Sports

The Chronicle / SATURDAY, JANUARY 27, 1996 **C1**



ROGER NEGIN

Conferences, schools face big decisions

There's no need to advise principals or Lorain County Conference member schools who'll decide, probably on Wednesday, what to do about the future of their league.

They know all the arguments, all the plusses and minuses. Now they've got to determine which direction to take.

Do they merely accept one school to replace Elyria West, which is being consolidated with Elyria High?

Do they take more than one and create a large conference?

Will they go contrary to the league's name and admit a non-Lorain County school?

By last Wednesday six schools already had sent letters of interest: Columbia of the MAC-8, Buckeye and Black River of the Mohican Area Conference, Midview and Vermilion of the Erie Shore and Lorain Catholic, an independent.

Black River and Buckeye are not Lorain County schools.

Mark McGuire, athletic director at Elyria Catholic, said the Panthers also might inquire about the spot.

North Ridgeville athletic director Tom McMahon said his school had not yet decided about submitting its name.

"That's kinda up to my bosses," he said.

The talk that we've heard is that only one school will be admitted, and that the favorite is Columbia. The other school prominently mentioned is Vermilion.

If it is Vermilion, that would drive another stake into the heart of the Erie Shore Conference, already a league in peril.

If it is Columbia, the six Erie Shore schools would have to decide whether they want to stay aligned or explore the possibility of going to the Lake Erie League. Erie Shore schools and the 10-school LEL will meet in Independence on Feb. 12 to determine if there is a future for a super-sized league.

The Pioneer Conference also could play a role because it will have an opening once Cloverleaf leaves for the Suburban League. Midview and Elyria have already expressed interest in the Pioneer.

None of the options appears bright for Vermilion, Midview and North Ridgeville — schools that would be smaller than teams affiliated with the LEL and other Erie Shore members.

One other choice could be alignment with the Ohio Heartland Conference, a five-school league that has long been searching for additional members. The OHC and the Erie Shore held a joint meeting last November to discuss common problems.

Travel to Lorain County is not an obstacle for members of the Ohio Heartland Conference, but commissioner Al Ward said it was a sticking point for Erie Shore members.

Ward said he has kept in touch with Erie Shore commissioner Dan Berenger. The talks have produced no action, but the opportunity is there if Erie Shore schools want to use it.

Heartland members are Ashland, Mansfield, Marion, Lexington and Mansfield Madison — many of them members of the old Cardinal Conference.

Ironically, three former Lorain County basketball coaches are head coaches in the Heartland: Firelands High grad Dennis Bartlett, former head coach at Keystone, is at Madison; former Elyria West coach Steve Mohr is at Marion Harding and former Wellington coach Jody Peters at Ashland.

The Heartland is trying to attract former Cardinal Conference member Wooster and Orrville to the league, Ward said.

Ward also said that Marion tried to leave the Heartland last

See **NEGIN**, C6

Ron Cook
Pittsburgh Post-Gazette

TEMPE, Ariz. — It turns out Troy Aikman is a better businessman than quarterback.

This is the sweet deal he has worked out with the Dallas Cowboys for his charity arm, the Troy Aikman Foundation. All the fine money his offensive linemen have to pay for being overweight

goes directly to helping needy kids in the Dallas area.

"I've donated a couple thousand," said guard Nate Newton, who is listed at 320 pounds but weighs at least 350.

"I've thrown a few coins into the pot," said center Derek Kennard, who is bigger than Newton.

"He's gotten 16 weeks of my money," said guard Larry Allen, who, at 326 jiggling pounds,

appears to be the runt of the litter.

Aikman appreciates it. "Every time I get their money, I send them a gift certificate to one of the Mexican restaurants in town. It's a self-perpetuating kind of thing. Those guys are my heroes in a lot of ways."

Mine, too. It is easy to dislike the Cowboys for a lot of reasons, namely

Jerry Jones and Barry Switzer and Deion Sanders and Michael Irvin. But it's awfully hard not to like their offensive linemen. They are fat, even obese. It is easy to relate.

Newton is the spokesman. Jerry Seinfeld has nothing on him as a stand-up comic. He learned a long time ago it pays to laugh at himself. Actually, it pays big.

"You guys will get me a lot more appearances after this week in the spotlight," Newton told a media throng this week. "But I'm not giving you 10 percent. I have to send that to Clinton."

Newton described his eating habits.

"Typically? All day."

A poster child for good health

See **FAT**, C3

Elyria West races to 12-1



TERRY MAHL/CHRONICLE

DRIVING BY:Elyria West's Robert Woolbright drives past Brookside's Bob Rosso.

Elyria dumps Rangers

Jerry Rombach
The Chronicle-Telegram

NORTH RIDGEVILLE — While Elyria won the game easily on the scoreboard, 84-61 at North Ridgeville Friday night, it was a lot closer in reality.

The Pioneers jumped out to a big 9-0 lead in the first minute and a half and never trailed in the Erie Shore Conference game, improving their league mark to 6-1 and overall to 7-6. Yet they could never quite put the Rangers (2-6 and 2-12) out of reach until the closing seconds.

Elyria would surge out to a big lead, North Ridgeville would come back and then the Pioneers would again streak to another commanding edge. That routine repeated itself throughout most of the game.

The Rangers only trailed by eight points, 61-53, with 7:25 left in the game, and only 10 with 3:41 remaining, 69-59, when they finally collapsed from just too much Bryan Todd and Elyria

See **PIONEERS**, C6



LINDA MURPHY/CHRONICLE

THE SLAM: Elyria's Danny Martin dunks against North Ridgeville.

SWC showdown goes to Bulldogs

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

AMHERST — Olmsted Falls won a big one, but coach Pat Donahue is not ready to claim a championship.

Amherst is two games behind the Bulldogs in the Southwestern Conference race with six to play, but coach Dave Zvara is not ready to concede.

"We've got a heckuva double-header next week," said Donahue after Friday's 59-57 Falls victory over Amherst. "But we control our own destiny. That's a nice thing to have."

The Bulldogs are 8-0 in the league; Amherst 6-2.

"They're a good team," Zvara said of Olmsted Falls. "But they play River and North Olmsted next week. That's a nasty weekend. We've got to keep going. We have to make sure we take care of business at hand."

Friday's game had a little of everything: Three-point shots, good offense, fine defense, drama and plenty of excitement.

The winning points, scored by Jerome Moore, came from the free throw line with 39.2 seconds left in the game. That gave the

visitors a 59-55 lead.

Todd Damasiewicz cut the lead to two eight seconds later. The Comets had a final chance after Damasiewicz made a steal with 19.3 seconds remaining.

Amherst worked the ball down to nine seconds and called a timeout.

"We decided in the huddle that we were going for the win," Zvara said. "We didn't want them to have another chance because we knew where they were going to go."

But Amherst didn't get the shot it wanted. Kris White, in the corner, couldn't get the ball and Jeremy Dusho, coming off the wing, also was covered, so Ray Deidrick threw the ball to Damasiewicz who made a move to the basket and missed a tough shot.

By the time Amherst got the ball back, only six-tenths of a second remained and the Comets had to go the entire floor. They didn't get a good shot.

The game's halves were as different as could be.

In the first half Falls shot 16-of-29 for 55 percent and sank 8-of-11 3-pointers in taking a 41-35

See **OLMSTED FALLS**, C4

NEWSPAPERARCHIVE

Elyria Chronicle Telegram, January 27, 1996, Pg. 15, Elyria, Ohio, US

<https://newspaperarchive.com/elyria-chronicle-telegram-jan-27-1996-p-15/>